Kellin Pelrine

Website | Google Scholar

Leading real-world impact from technical foundations.

Education

Ph.D. Machine Learning, McGill University, 2020-2025
Supervisors: Reihaneh Rabbany, Jean-François Godbout
M.A. Economics, Yale University, 2018-2019
M.S. Applied Mathematics, University of Colorado Boulder, 2017-2018
B.A. Economics and Mathematics, University of Colorado Boulder, 2014-2018
Class Rank 1, "Summa cum laude in economics" and "With Distinction"

Professional Experience

FAR AI

Head of Technology, Frontier Safety October 2026 – Present
Member of Technical Staff, June 2025 – October 2026
Research Scientist, January 2025 – June 2025
Research Advisor, June 2023 – January 2025
Research Scientist Intern, December 2022 – June 2023

Leading work to make AI trustworthy and secure.

Founded FAR.AI red-teaming function.
Our findings have improved safeguards deployed in most of the leading AI systems, like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini.
Built 0 → 5 people, onboarded co-founder, 5 → 11 people.
Expanded scope as a new and scaling division, focused on red-teaming, evaluations, and safeguards for frontier risks.

Led creation of the AI Security Leaderboard and FAR.AI Minimal Standard for Safeguards, V1.0
Showed hundred-fold gap in safeguards of leading models
Reported in WIRED, CNBC

Built partnerships with multiple frontier companies (e.g., OpenAI) and governments (e.g., the European Commission).

Showed strongly superhuman capabilities will not be sufficient for robustness.

Called the "man who beat the machine"

Paper 1 reported in Financial Times, The Times, Ars Technica, Vice

Paper 2 reported in Nature, Ars Technica, Scientific American

Orals at ICML and AAAI, and cited in US Senate testimony

Led projects to solve persuasion risks.

Built partnership with professors at MIT, Cornell, Mila, CMU, and CIDE.

Found Gemini would comply with requests to persuade people to join terrorist groups and other crimes – no jailbreaking needed – resulting in Google taking action to fix the gap in safeguards.

Discovered jailbreak-tuning, the most severe blackbox fine-tuning attack.

Showed increasingly capable AI is increasingly vulnerable to data poisoning.

FAR.AI "Spirit" Award – for "energy, curiosity, and bold ambition"

FAR.AI "Integrity" Award – for "doing the right thing, even when it's hard"

Stitch

Cofounder and CTO, December 2023 – November 2024

Led development of a graphical interface for LLMs: organized, faster, deeper interactions.

Mutual

Cofounder and Chief Scientist, June 2023 – December 2023

Led R&D to create consistent, reliable, and powerful generative AI agents.

Machine Learning Sports

Cofounder and CTO, October 2019 – December 2020

Created a recommendation system to help professional baseball pitchers optimize their pitch selection.

Go (strategy board game)

Professional teacher, freelance

Volunteer teacher, multiple Go clubs and online

Students have won tournaments and awards.

Other Research Leadership

Information Integrity in the GenAI Era

Project Director, January 2023 – August 2025

In coordination with PIs Reihaneh Rabbany and Jean-François Godbout, built tools to help people find reliable information and avoid being misled by manipulation from both humans and AI.

Initiated and supervised over a dozen subprojects: evidence retrieval, credibility assessment, simulations, uncertainty quantification, explainability, datasets, evaluation, fieldbuilding, and more.

This work and its continuation was highlighted as one of three examples of research → real world impact in Canada's National AI Strategy.

AI for Human Resilience

Project Director, February 2025 – August 2025

Demonstrated potential of AI as a fallible peer rather than authoritative teacher.

Workshop Organizer

Social Simulation with LLMs, COLM, 2025

Temporal Graph Learning (TGL), NeurIPS, 2022 and 2023

Opening remarks at first edition (2022).

These workshops led to the creation of a community with over 400 researchers, a recurring seminar series, and continuing series of workshops.

Axiom Futures Fellowship

Mentor, Summer 2024

Project (Simulations to Solve Societal-Scale Manipulation) went on to secure over $500K funding, multiple publications, and an ongoing research agenda.

Mentees: Gayatri Krishna Kumar, Sneheel Sarangi.

Supervised Program for Alignment Research (SPAR)

Mentor, Spring+Fall 2023, Spring+Summer 2024, Spring+Fall 2025

Mentored 40+ researchers in AI safety. Mentees co-authored 8 conference papers and dozens of workshop papers.

Mentees (ordered roughly chronologically): Caleb Gupta, Joel Christoph, Meilina Reksoprodjo, James Zhou, Lynn Feng, Mayank Goel, Raghav Ravi, Roman Hauksson, Tyler Vergho, Yury Orlovskiy, Arjun Verma, Arturs Semenuks, George Ingebretsen, Ruben Weijers, Gabrielle Castilho, Dylan Tabarini, Michael Walters, Will Cai, Ethan Kosak-Hine, Jason Zhang, Julius Broomfield, Reihaneh Iranmanesh, Sara Pieri, Tom Gibbs, Nikita Agarwal, Austin Welch, Toshali Goel, Kushal Dev, Luda Cohen, Sukanya Krishna, Hikaru Tsujimura, Ardy Haroen, Deeraj Nagothu, Joshua Levy, Denis Volk, Anna Marchenkova,

Igor Ivanov, Arth Singh, Mithil Srungarapu, Akash Kundu, Luis Ibanez, Adam Divak, Stephanie Ding, Yernat Yestekov.

Thesis Supervision

Co-supervisor, master's thesis of Ruben Weijers, Utrecht University, graduated 2025

Honors and Awards

Go (strategy board game)

U.S. Team Member, World Mind Sports Games, 2012

95 countries competed. Invitation based on U.S. ranking and tournament results.

U.S. Team Member, China-US Internet Go Tournament, 2020

One of 6 players selected by ranking to represent the U.S. in a friendship match with top Chinese amateurs.

Playoff for North American representative to Li Min Cup, 2014 and 2016

One of 8 participants by invitation.

Violin

Participant, 2 masterclasses of renowned pedagogue Zakhar Bron, 2012

By invitation and audition.

Research and Academic (graduate)

Doctoral Training Scholarship, CAD 58k, Fonds de Recherche du Québec, 2023

Graduate Excellence Award, CAD 48k total, McGill University, 5 times, 2020-2023

GREAT Award, CAD 2k total, McGill University, 2 times, 2022 and 2023

IVADO PhD Excellence Scholarship, CAD 75k, IVADO, 2021

Max Stern Recruitment Fellowship, CAD 14k, McGill University, 2020

Cowles Foundation Fellowship, USD 32k, Yale University, 2018

Academic (undergraduate)

Chancellor's Recognition Award, CU Boulder, for perfect GPA, 2018

Sieglinde Talbott Haller Economics Scholarship, CU Boulder, 2016 and 2017

Jim and Laura Marshall Scholarship, CU Boulder, mathematics, 2016

Flock Leader Scholarship, CU Boulder, 2015

CU Esteemed Scholars Program: President Joseph A. Sewall Award, 2014

Selected Conference and Journal Papers

*equal contribution, †equal advising

TamperBench: Systematically Stress-Testing LLM Safety Under Fine-Tuning and Tampering
Saad Hossain, Tom Tseng, Punya Syon Pandey, Samanvay Vajpayee, Nayeema Nonta, Matthew Kowal, Samuel Simko, Stephen Casper, Zhijing Jin, **Kellin Pelrine,** Sirisha Rambhatla

KDD 2026 (**Oral**)

Open Technical Problems in Open-Weight AI Model Risk Management
Stephen Casper, Kyle O'Brien, Shayne Longpre, Elizabeth Seger, Kevin Klyman, Rishi Bommasani, Aniruddha Nrusimha, Ilia Shumailov, Sören Mindermann, Steven Basart, Frank Rudzicz, **Kellin Pelrine**, Avijit Ghosh, Andrew Strait, Robert Kirk, Dan Hendrycks, Peter Henderson, J Zico Kolter, Geoffrey Irving, Yarin Gal, Yoshua Bengio, Dylan Hadfield-Menell
TMLR (**Survey Certificate** for "exceptionally thorough or insightful survey")

Jailbreak-Tuning: Safeguards of Fine-Tunable Models are Illusory
Brendan Murphy, Dillon Bowen, Shahrad Mohammedzadeh, Tom Tseng, Julius Broomfield, Adam Gleave, **Kellin Pelrine**
EMNLP 2025

A Guide to Misinformation Detection Datasets
Camille Thibault[*], Jacob-Junqi Tian[*], Gabrielle Péloquin-Skulski, Taylor Lynn Curtis, James Zhou, Florence Laflamme, Yuxiang Guan, Reihaneh Rabbany, Jean-François Godbout, **Kellin Pelrine**
KDD Datasets and Benchmarks Track 2025 (**Best Paper Runner Up**, top 3 of accepted papers)

Can Go AIs be adversarially robust?
Tom Tseng, Euan McLean, **Kellin Pelrine**[†], Tony Tong Wang[†], Adam Gleave[†]
AAAI 2025 (**Oral**)

Scaling Trends for Data Poisoning in LLMs
Dillon Bowen, Brendan Murphy, Will Cai, David Khachaturov, Adam Gleave[†], **Kellin Pelrine**[†]
AAAI 2025

Towards Reliable Misinformation Mitigation: Generalization, Uncertainty, and GPT-4
Kellin Pelrine, Anne Imouza, Camille Thibault, Meilina Reksoprodjo, Caleb Gupta, Joel Christoph, Jean-François Godbout, Reihaneh Rabbany
EMNLP 2023

Adversarial Policies Beat Superhuman Go AIs
Tony Tong Wang[*], Adam Gleave[*], Tom Tseng, **Kellin Pelrine**, Nora Belrose, Joseph Miller, Michael D Dennis, Yawen Duan, Viktor Pogrebniak, Sergey Levine, Stuart Russell
ICML 2023 (**Oral**)

Towards Better Evaluation for Dynamic Link Prediction
Farimah Poursafaei[*], Andy Huang[*], **Kellin Pelrine**, Reihaneh Rabbany
NeurIPS Datasets and Benchmarks Track 2022

The Surprising Performance of Simple Baselines for Misinformation Detection
Kellin Pelrine[*], Jacob Danovitch[*], Reihaneh Rabbany
The Web Conference 2021

Selected Workshop Papers

Exposing the Systematic Vulnerability of Open-Weight Models to Prefill Attacks
Lukas Struppek, Adam Gleave,, **Kellin Pelrine**
AI4Good @ ICML 2026 (**Outstanding Paper Honorable Mention**)

Emergent Persuasion: Will LLMs Persuade Without Being Prompted?
Vincent Chang, Thee Ho, Sunishchal Dev, Kevin Zhu, Shi Feng, **Kellin Pelrine**, Matthew Kowal
AIGOV @ AAAI 2026 (**Oral**)

From Intuition to Understanding: Using AI Peers to Overcome Physics Misconceptions
Ruben Weijers, Denton Wu, Hannah Betts, Tamara Jacod, Yuxiang Guan, Vidya Sujaya, Kushal Dev, Toshali Goel, William Delooze, Reihaneh Rabbany, Ying Wu, Jean-François Godbout, **Kellin Pelrine**
ICLR 2025 Workshops: AI4CHL (**Oral**), FM-WILD, Bi-Align

A Guide to Misinformation Detection Datasets
Camille Thibault[*], Jacob-Junqi Tian[*], Gabrielle Péloquin-Skulski, Taylor Lynn Curtis, James Zhou, Florence Laflamme, Yuxiang Guan, Reihaneh Rabbany, Jean-François Godbout, **Kellin Pelrine**
ICLR 2025 Workshops: MLDPR (**Spotlight**), SCSL

A Simulation System Towards Solving Societal-Scale Manipulation
Maximilian Puelma Touzel[*], Sneheel Sarangi[*], Austin Welch[*], Gayatri Krishnakumar, Dan Zhao, Zachary Yang, Hao Yu, Ethan Kosak-Hine, Tom Gibbs, Andreea Musulan, Camille Thibault, Busra Tugce Gurbuz, Reihaneh Rabbany, Jean-François Godbout, **Kellin Pelrine**
NeurIPS 2024 Workshops: SATA (**Oral**), SoLaR, SafeGenAI

Selected Other Research

AI Epistemic Risks: Emerging Mechanisms & Evidence
Mick Yang, Stephen Casper, Jonathan Stray, Jasmine Li, Cameron Jones, Anna Gausen, Natasha Jaques, Brian Christian, Bálint Gyevnár, Hannah Rose Kirk, Zhonghao He, Dan Zhao, Siao Si Looi, Joshua Levy, Kobi Hackenburg, Elizabeth Seger, Matt Kowal, Michelle Malonza, Luke Hewitt, Hause Lin, Maarten Sap, Dylan Hadfield-Menell, Thomas H. Costello, Reihaneh Rabbany, Jean-François Godbout, David G. Rand, Atoosa Kasirzadeh, Gordon Pennycook, Yoshua Bengio, **Kellin Pelrine**. 2026.

Large language models can effectively convince people to believe conspiracies
Thomas H. Costello, **Kellin Pelrine**, Matthew Kowal, Antonio A. Arechar, Jean-François Godbout, Adam Gleave, David Rand, Gordon Pennycook. 2026.

Securing Agentic AI - A Discussion Paper
Cyber Security Agency of Singapore, **FAR.AI**. 2025. (contributed as FAR.AI lead on this project)

It's the Thought that Counts: Evaluating the Attempts of Frontier LLMs to Persuade on Harmful Topics
Matthew Kowal, Jasper Timm, Jean-François Godbout, Thomas Costello, Antonio A. Arechar, Gordon Pennycook, David Rand, Adam Gleave, **Kellin Pelrine**. 2025.

Exploiting novel GPT-4 APIs
Kellin Pelrine[*], Mohammad Taufeeque[*], Michał Zając, Euan McLean, Adam Gleave. 2024.

Open, Closed, or Small Language Models for Text Classification?
Hao Yu, Zachary Yang, **Kellin Pelrine**, Jean Francois Godbout, Reihaneh Rabbany. 2023.